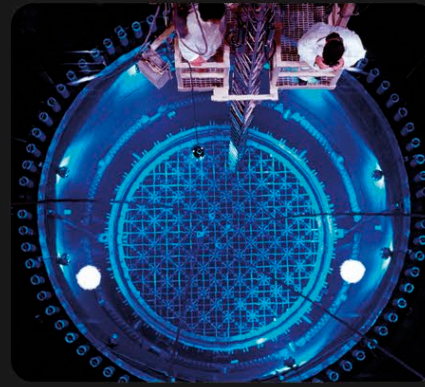
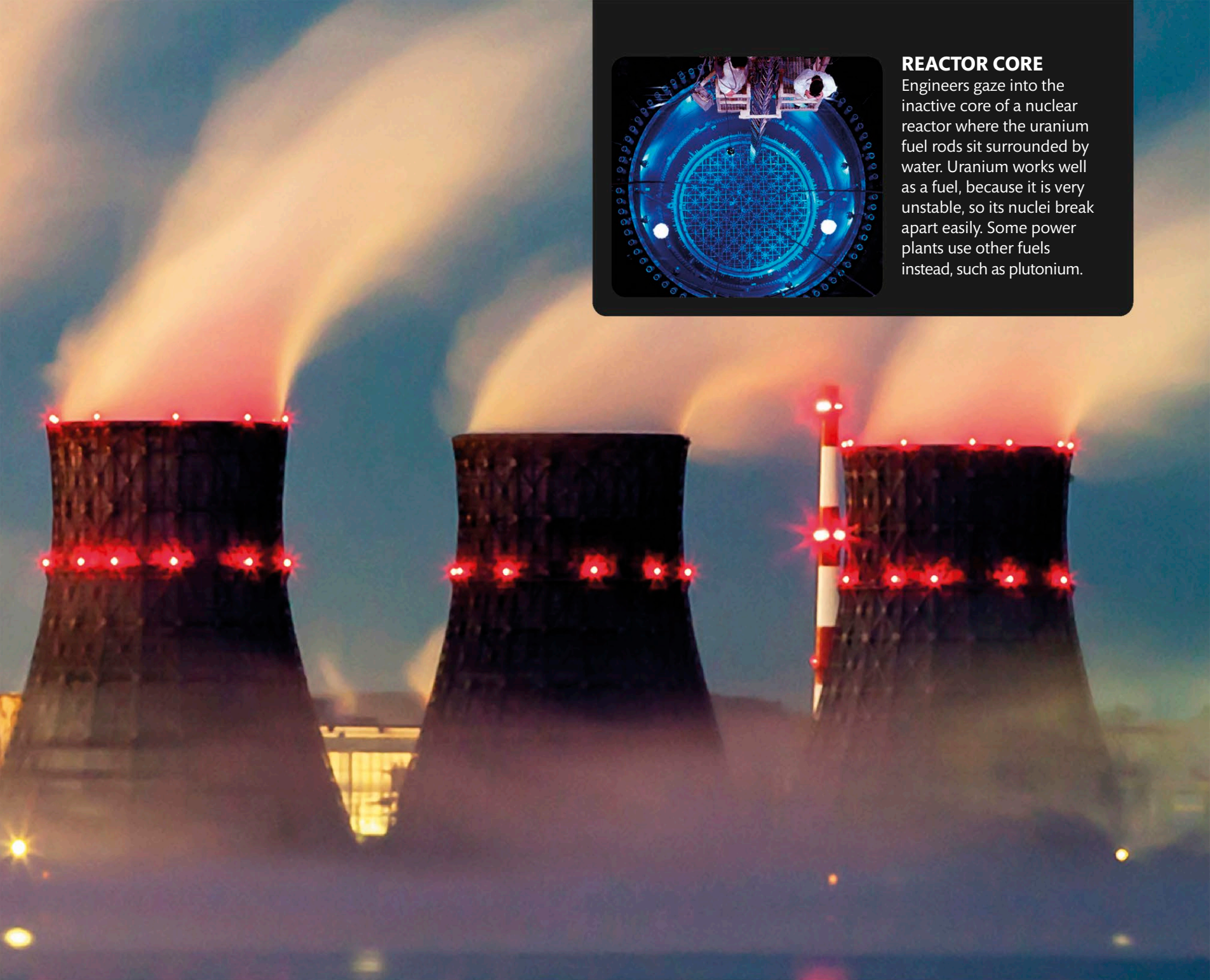




REACTOR CORE

Engineers gaze into the inactive core of a nuclear reactor where the uranium fuel rods sit surrounded by water. Uranium works well as a fuel, because it is very unstable, so its nuclei break apart easily. Some power plants use other fuels instead, such as plutonium.

From fission to electricity

Nuclear fission reactions happen in a part of a power station called the reactor core. Control rods made of graphite are lowered and raised in between rods made of uranium. The graphite absorbs neutrons and can be used to slow the chain reaction if needed. The heat of the chain reaction is used to boil water into steam, which is then sent through turbines to generate electricity.

